EXPERIMENT 11

Deploying a Zoho Creator Application from Development to Production Environment

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Subject: Low Code Application Development using Zoho Creator
Project: Bank Loan Application & Pre-Screening Management

Aim

To demonstrate the development-to-production release path of the Loan Application using the Environments feature of Zoho Creator, so that changes are built, tested and released in a controlled manner.

Introduction to Multi-Stage Deployment

A bank cannot test a change on the application that loan officers are using. Zoho Creator's Environments feature gives a multi-stage release path: each environment is a separate, isolated copy of the application with its own forms, reports, workflows and data. A change made in one environment does not reach the next until it is deliberately deployed.

Table 11.1: The three environments

Environment	Purpose	Who works there
Development	Build and change the application; unit-test each form, report and workflow	Developer
Stage	Test the deployed build with realistic data before release (acceptance testing)	Developer and tester / loan officer
Production	Live application used by applicants and bank staff	End users

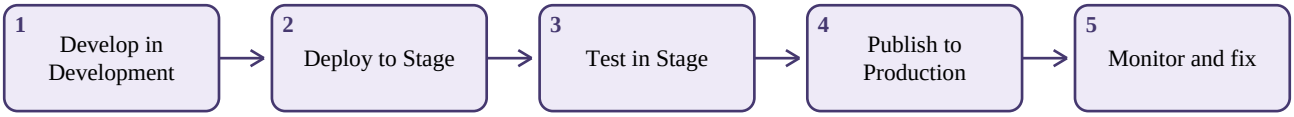


Fig 11.1 — Deployment pipeline (schematic drawn from the specification; not a screenshot)

Procedure

1. Open **Environments** from the Deploy section of the Creator workspace and locate Loan Application & Pre-Screening Management.
2. Complete a small change in Development, for example adding the field Documents_Complete, and note that the application shows that changes are available.
3. Choose **Deploy** to move the application from Development to Stage and note the version created.
4. In Stage, run the test checklist of Table 11.2 with sample applications.
5. If the tests pass, **Publish** the application from Stage to Production. If a test fails, return to Development, correct the fault and deploy again.
6. Open the Version History to see the versions and the date and time of each deployment.
7. Open the production link and submit one real-looking application to confirm the live form works.

Note: the Environments feature and the number of environments available depend on the Zoho Creator plan. Record what the account actually shows in the screenshots; if only one stage is available, say so in the observations instead of describing stages that were not used.

Stage Test Checklist

Table 11.2: Checks carried out in the Stage environment (to be completed)

Check	Expected result	Result
Form loads and all 30 fields appear	Fields in the right sections	
Mandatory and format validations	Invalid data is refused	
Acknowledgement e-mail	Received with reference number	
Reports and page	Open with sample data	
Roles	Loan Officer cannot delete or export	
Workflows	Form workflow, schedule and approval run as designed	

Why Separate Environments

- Faults are found in Stage, not by applicants.
- Production data is never edited while building.
- A tested version is released, not a half-finished change.
- The version history gives a record of what was released and when.

Output

SCREENSHOT TO ATTACH

Environments page showing the application in Development, Stage and Production columns

Fig 11.2 — Environments dashboard

SCREENSHOT TO ATTACH

Deploy dialog and the resulting version in Stage

Fig 11.3 — Deploying to Stage

SCREENSHOT TO ATTACH

Version History page

Fig 11.4 — Version history

SCREENSHOT TO ATTACH

Production link of the live Loan Application form

Fig 11.5 — Production form

Result

The Loan Application was moved through the Development, Stage and Production path, with a test checklist applied in Stage before release.

Conclusion

Multi-stage deployment separates building, testing and using the application. For a bank’s loan process this reduces the risk that an untested change reaches live applicants and leaves a version record for audit.